Off-Plan Research & Advisory

Dubai South Off-Plan Comparison

South Living vs South Square

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BOTH 72/100	**Two strong Dubai South plays — choose by goal: South Living for yield & faster handover, South Square for growth & product.**

Side-by-Side Comparison

	South Living	South Square
Developer	Dubai South Properties (govt-backed)	Dubai South Properties (govt-backed)
District	Residential District	Logistics City district
Concept	Residential — gardens, pool-villa views	Wellness-led — water ponds, green corridors
Unit types	Studio · 1 · 2 · 3-bed	1 · 2 · 2.5 · 3-bed
Entry price	**Studio fr AED 600K · 1BR fr 1.0M**	1BR fr ~AED 1.1–1.43M
2-Bed from	~AED 1.2M	~AED 1.6–2.0M
3-Bed	~AED 1.85M	AED 2.2–2.9M
Price / sqft	~1,300–1,400	~1,000–1,460
Gross yield	**~6–7.5%** (studio/1BR best)	~5.5% (2–3BR)
Net yield	~4.5–6%	~4.0–4.5%
Handover	**Q1 2027 (sooner)**	Q4 2028
Payment plan	5 / 55 / 16 + 24% PHP (2-yr) — 76/24	5 / 55 / 20 + 20% PHP (2-yr) — 80/20
Key catalyst	Al Maktoum Airport + Expo City	Al Maktoum Airport + Expo City
Launch demand	Strong	**First tower sold out in ~3 hrs**
Investment Score	72 / 100	72 / 100

All figures AED. Both projects offer a 2-year post-handover payment plan.

Payment Plan Comparison

Stage	South Living	South Square
Down payment (booking)	5%	5%
During construction	55%	55%
On handover	16% (Q1 2027)	20% (Q4 2028)
Post-handover (2 years)	24%	20%

Both reach handover at ~76–80% paid, with the balance spread over **24 months after handover** — so the unit can be leased and rent applied toward the tail.

The Verdict on Each

South Living	**72 / 100**

The cash-flow & speed pick. Lowest entry (studio fr AED 600K, 1BR fr AED 1.0M), the best yields on this list (~6–7.5% gross on studios/1BR), and the SOONER handover — Q1 2027 — so rental income starts ~18 months earlier. Residential District, gardens and pool-villa-view layouts, with a 2-year post-handover tail.

Best for: yield-focused & first-time investors who want lower entry and faster completion.

South Square	**72 / 100**

The appreciation & product pick. A wellness-led design (water ponds, green corridors, larger 2–3BR family units) in Logistics City, with explosive launch demand (first tower sold out in ~3 hours) supporting resale/assignment liquidity. Longer build to Q4 2028 with an 80/20 plan.

Best for: medium-term capital-growth buyers who want a premium product and bigger units, and can wait to 2028.

Recommendation

Both score 72/100 — the right pick depends on the client's goal:

Client priority	Recommended project
Earliest handover / fastest rental income	South Living — Q1 2027
Lowest entry & best yield (studio/1BR)	South Living
Capital growth, premium wellness product, bigger family units	South Square
Strongest resale / assignment liquidity	South Square (sold-out launches)

Key Considerations & Risks

- Both sit in Dubai South — a heavy 2026–28 off-plan pipeline that can soften rents and resale around handover.
- Net yields on larger 2–3BR units are modest (~4–4.5%); the strongest cash-on-cash is South Living studios/1BR.
- The airport-led growth thesis is multi-year; metro/retail/schools are still building out (car-dependent today).
- Both are off-plan — confirm the exact price list, unit size, service charge, handover date and payment plan in the SPA.
- Government-backed developer lowers delivery risk, but exit timing (2027 vs 2028) still carries market-cycle risk.

Thank you

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